



G. SADASHIVA REDDY, 27

Design engineer

Hyderabad blasts, August 25, 2007

WHAT HAPPENED LYING IN THE HOSPITAL IN A VEGETATED STATE

"Is he alive or dead for us? You can decide for yourself," says G. Vasantha, pointing to her younger son Sadashiva, now a paraplegic with a damaged brain, who cannot speak, see through the left eye, sit straight or have a meal. But this is what timely medical attention for five months could barely achieve for Sadashiva who has pellets inside his head and body as a grim and poignant reminder

of the deadly blast at the popular eatery Gokul Chat.

His brother Srinivas approached Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy to extend the benefits—grant of Rs 5 lakh and a government job for next of kin. In spite of an assurance by the chief minister on December 18 last year and again on July 31 this year, the bureaucracy is yet to find ways to deliver the benefits. The family now depends on the income of his father, Mohan Reddy, a low-ranked employee in a government-run printing press in the city, to take care of Sadashiva. "We wait with hope even as blasts in other cities remind us of how our dear one has been snatched away though he is physically present with us," says Srinivas.

SHAIKESH RAVAL



VINOD PODDAR, 43

Government employee

Delhi blasts, October 29, 2005

WHAT HAPPENED LOST HIS RIGHT LEG AND HIS SON. DAUGHTER SUSTAINED SERIOUS INJURIES.

On the evening of a pre-Diwali shopping frenzy at Delhi's Sarojini Nagar market, an IED blast turned Vinod Poddar into a human torch, blowing his right leg off and mangling his left arm. Even as Poddar flailed about in the flames, he watched his seven-year-old son Karan die and 13-year-

REUBEN SINGH



old daughter Tanvi's limbs turn into a bloody mess. It was the nearly two-year wait for the Rs 1 lakh compensation from the Delhi government, which went into paying for a prosthetic limb. Today, the sole breadwinner of a five-member family, which includes his mother, worries about the cost of medical expenses which are likely to stalk him like a ghost for the rest of his life. "The dead suffer no pain," he philosophises. "For survivors like us, every moment is agony. Each time I hear of a blast, I just pray that the survivors don't have to undergo what I have gone through."